

AASHISH CHHABRA

Gurugram, Haryana, India · chhabra.aashish23@gmail.com · +91-7875570666 · linkedin.com/in/aashishchhabra

SUMMARY

Senior Lead DevOps & Big Data Platform Engineer with **12+ years** architecting and operating infrastructure at scale — and, in parallel, leading the team that runs it. Scaled a production Cloudera cluster from 20 to 400+ Datanodes (19 PB) and led its zero-downtime CDH 5.8 → CDP 7.1.6 migration. Manages a critical footprint of 1,200+ bare-metal servers behind a pluggable, multi-language CI/CD framework with DevSecOps security gates developers can't bypass. Currently leads a team of 3 Java developers and 5 DevOps engineers, architects the move of an internal data mesh platform to Airtel B2B Cloud alongside product and engineering managers, and owns container security across every containerised deployment and its CI/CD pipeline — while staying hands-on with Kafka cluster administration, OpenShift/Kubernetes, and full-stack observability with the Elastic Stack.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Big Data & Data Processing: Cloudera (CDH/CDP), HDP, Apache Kafka (Admin/SCRAM/Kerberos), Hive, SQOOP, Spark Operator, Trino, YARN, Zookeeper, Airflow

DevOps & Orchestration: Ansible, Jenkins CI/CD, Pluggable Multi-Language CI/CD Framework, DevSecOps (BlackDuck, Coverity, Prisma Cloud), GitOps

Containerization & Cloud: OpenShift Container Platform (OCP), Kubernetes, Docker Swarm, Docker, Microsoft Azure (AZ-900 Certified), Google Cloud Platform, Airtel Cloud

Observability & Reliability: Elastic Stack (ELK/APM/Fleet), Grafana, Synthetics, OpenTelemetry, Kafka UI

Languages & Tools: Python (Pandas), Shell Scripting, MySQL, Oracle SQL, Cluster Shell, JupyterHub

System-Level Engineering: RHEL/CentOS (7.x–8.x), Kernel Parameter Tuning, Systemd Services, RPM/TAR Packaging

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Xtelify (Airtel Digital / Bharti Airtel Limited), Gurugram, India

Senior Lead Engineer — Data Techops | September 2019 – Present

- Leads a team of 3 Java developers and 5 DevOps engineers; drives the CI/CD strategy directly with the DevOps reportees and mentors engineers on peer teams on production issues, scaling problems, and career growth.
- Architects the move of an internal data mesh platform to Airtel B2B Cloud alongside product and engineering managers — closing FRDs with product managers and authoring the HLD/LLD documentation for the services personally designed.
- Partners with Nxtra (Airtel Data Centre) infrastructure, network, and storage architects on cross-layer design for new Airtel B2B Cloud services.
- Owns container security architecture across every containerised deployment and its CI/CD pipeline integration.
- Contributes to annual appraisal cycles and talent council discussions, and leads annual capacity planning for on-prem bare-metal infrastructure across multiple projects.
- Scaled the production Cloudera cluster from 20 to 400+ Datanodes (19 PB); planned and executed a Namenode bare-metal server switch with zero downtime.
- Led the CDH 5.8 → CDP 7.1.6 migration in lockstep with Developers and Operations, with zero business downtime.
- Architected and stabilised a Kafka platform on kernel-tuned bare-metal brokers supporting high-speed streaming ingestion from across India: dual Kerberos/SCRAM authentication, Cruise Control for rebalancing, and real-time observability via Grafana, Kafka UI, and Telegram alerting.
- Led the migration of in-house applications and microservices from Docker Swarm to OpenShift Container Platform (OCP); deployed OpenShift Local across multiple VMs for live debugging in production-like, isolated developer environments.

- Built and maintains a pluggable, multi-language CI/CD framework enforcing DevSecOps security gates developers can't bypass, integrating BlackDuck, Coverity, and Prisma Cloud into CI pipelines.
- Built full-stack observability across platforms — centralised logging (ELK), APM tracing, Fleet-managed agents, and Synthetics — and manages upgrades for the Elastic Stack clusters (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana, Elastic Agents).
- Deployed and manages Trino on Kubernetes with Kerberos-authenticated connectivity, Spark Operator on OpenShift, and LDAP-authenticated JupyterHub for Spark workloads.
- Manages 1,200+ bare-metal servers across production environments; planned and deployed disaster recovery for the production Cloudera platform.
- Drives application uptime and reliability through diagnostics at the OS and network-protocol level to eliminate systemic infrastructure bottlenecks.

NCR Corporation, Gurugram, India

Senior Software Engineer | January 2018 – September 2019

- Deployed and managed multiple Hortonworks Data Platform (HDP) clusters, configuring YARN, Ranger, Hive, Knox, and Oozie for optimal performance, and executed minor and major version upgrades across them.
- Implemented Kerberos for seamless Active Directory authentication across all HDP cluster components.
- Deployed DataProc clusters and Hadoop-on-GCP VMs for cross-cloud workloads.
- Automated HDP user onboarding via Ranger Sync and managed user privileges/Ranger policies using custom shell scripts.
- Coordinated with the Unix team on the acquisition, installation, and configuration of CentOS 7 servers.
- Built data pipelines using SQOOP from MySQL/Oracle into Hadoop, with Hive DDL/DML for transformation, and automated partition repair across Hive schemas post-ingestion.
- Used Cluster Shell for configuration management and bulk operations across multiple production clusters; developed Python/Pandas scripts to analyse cluster job data for administrative reporting.
- Provided 24/7 on-call support, troubleshooting production cluster issues and job failures.

Tech Mahindra Ltd., Pune, India

Software Engineer | June 2014 – December 2017

- Contributed to multiple proof-of-concepts migrating data storage from traditional RDBMS to HDFS to meet growing big-data analysis needs.
- Built SQOOP pipelines importing data from Microsoft SQL Server into HDFS, and Hive/PIG Latin scripts to transform it for the Quotations-to-Orders use case.
- Contributed to application high-level design under the Iterative Waterfall Model, authoring HLD documents to organisational standards.
- Engineered MySQL/SQL Server database work: table optimisation, stored procedures and functions powering daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly, and yearly reports, and backup scripts for data integrity and recovery.
- Enhanced JSP frontend views and prepared deployment documentation for production releases.

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

Certifications: Management Development Programme — IIM Indore, 2024 · Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900), 2024 · HDP Certified Developer — Hortonworks Inc., 2017

Bharti Airtel Ltd.: Employee of the Month, Eureka Award, Best Team Award · **Tech Mahindra:** ACE Award, Bravo Award (two quarters), Highest Learner Award, Pat on the Back Award, Best Team Award (two alternate quarters)